```
class Song
  @@count = 0

  def initialize
    @@count += 1
  end

  def Song.get_count
    @@count
  end
end
```

Class variables belong to the innermost enclosing class or module at the point they are defined. You can not use a class variables at the top level, you will receive a RuntimeError.

Class variables are inherited by children but propagate upward if first defined in a child:

```
class Top
  @@A = "top A"
  @@B = "top B"
  def dump
    puts values
  end
  def values
    "#{self.class.name}: @@A = #@@A, @@B = #@@B"
  end
end

class MiddleOne < Top
  @@B = "One B"
  @@C = "One C"
  def values
    super + ", C = #@@C"
  end
end

class MiddleTwo < Top
  @@B = "Two B"
  @@C = "Two C"
  def values
    super + ", C = #@@C"
  end
end

class BottomOne < MiddleOne; end

class BottomTwo < MiddleTwo; end

Top.new.dump
MiddleOne.new.dump
MiddleTwo.new.dump
BottomOne.new.dump
BottomTwo.new.dump
```

produces:

```
Top: @@A = top A, @@B = Two B
MiddleOne: @@A = top A, @@B = Two B, C = One C
MiddleTwo: @@A = top A, @@B = Two B, C = Two C
BottomOne: @@A = top A, @@B = Two B, C = One C
```